

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Architecture | Microsoft Sentinel | Cloud Security | Threat Detection

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over 5 years of experience designing and implementing security architectures, driving security best practices across complex cloud and on-premises estates, and leading threat detection and incident response programmes. I bring extensive expertise in the Microsoft security technology stack, including Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and cloud security in Microsoft Azure with Entra ID and Conditional Access. My experience includes leading threat modelling exercises, conducting security risk assessments, and delivering security design reviews for large-scale infrastructure and cloud adoption initiatives. I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with a strong track record of reducing organisational risk through practical security architecture implementation, continuous SIEM improvement using Kusto Query Language (KQL), and driving security visibility and response capability across 8,000-user environments. I thrive working within large international organisations investing in technology transformation, bringing both strategic security thinking and hands-on engineering delivery.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Architecture:** Design and implementation of security architectures and controls across cloud, hybrid, and on-premises environments; security design reviews for infrastructure and application change
- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL analytics rules, data connectors, watchlists, workbooks, Logic Apps); CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; alert quality improvement and detection coverage management
- **Cloud Security (Azure / Microsoft 365):** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access policy design, Identity Governance, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Microsoft Defender for Cloud
- **Endpoint Protection:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, Insight, Discover); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Tanium
- **Threat Detection and Incident Response:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned threat modelling, threat hunting, and detection engineering; NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle
- **Vulnerability and Exposure Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; risk-rated remediation planning and tracking
- **Identity and Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO); least privilege enforcement
- **Security Risk Assessments:** Security risk identification, threat modelling (STRIDE, MITRE ATT&CK), risk register management, security governance reporting
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell scripting, Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps (SOAR), automated security controls and reporting workflows
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, MCSA, CompTIA A+, Google IT Support Professional Certificate

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Design and implement security architectures and controls across cloud and on-premises environments, including Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365, and Entra ID, ensuring security is embedded into infrastructure and application designs from the outset.

- Drive security best practices across projects and operational activities, conducting threat modelling, security risk assessments, and security design reviews for new technologies, cloud migration initiatives, and large-scale transformation programmes.
- Lead and manage the Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) estate, improving detection coverage, alert quality, and overall response capability through continuous Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rule development and tuning.
- Support security monitoring, threat detection, and incident response activities, investigating security incidents across endpoints, networks, cloud environments, and identity platforms, using MITRE ATT&CK to guide analysis.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate, maintaining comprehensive endpoint visibility and proactive threat response capability.
- Lead cloud security initiatives, designing and implementing Conditional Access policies, Identity Governance frameworks, and Privileged Access Management (PAM) controls in Microsoft Azure Entra ID.
- Conduct vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), producing risk-rated assessments and coordinating remediation across infrastructure and application development teams.
- Implement and maintain security automation capabilities using PowerShell scripting and Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks, reducing manual analyst effort and improving response consistency.
- Provide technical security guidance to project teams, acting as the subject matter expert for security architecture decisions during new technology procurement, system integration, and cloud adoption projects.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Supported the design and implementation of security controls across a complex, multi-site university technology estate encompassing cloud, on-premises, and hybrid infrastructure.
- Managed the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, creating and tuning KQL-based analytics rules and supporting security incident investigations aligned to MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs).
- Conducted security risk assessments and provided security guidance for infrastructure and application change requests, ensuring appropriate controls were designed and implemented.
- Led cloud security initiatives including Conditional Access policy design, Azure Active Directory (AD) hardening, and identity governance configuration, supporting the organisation's cloud adoption journey.
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Nessus and Tenable.io, tracking remediation across 8,000+ endpoints and coordinating with infrastructure teams to close identified risks within agreed timescales.
- Delivered security design reviews for major infrastructure projects, providing technical input and recommending security controls aligned to NIST CSF, CIS Controls, and Cyber Essentials Plus frameworks.
- Contributed to security architecture improvements, proposing and implementing technical controls to strengthen the security posture across endpoint, identity, and network domains.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented security architecture improvements across a cloud-hosted SaaS/FinTech environment, including firewall rule management, endpoint protection deployment, SIEM log integration, and identity access management configuration.
- Conducted risk assessments and security reviews for infrastructure and application changes, recommending and implementing technical controls to address identified risks.
- Maintained cloud security configuration and security tooling for a hybrid cloud environment, ensuring alignment to ISO 27001 and internal security policies.
- Supported incident response activities, assisting with investigation, containment, and documentation of security events.
- Delivered security guidance to development and infrastructure teams on secure configuration, access management, and vulnerability remediation best practices.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led a comprehensive overhaul of the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM estate, authoring 40+ KQL detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing false positive rates by over 30% and significantly improving detection coverage across endpoint, cloud, and identity domains.
- Designed and implemented Conditional Access and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) architecture across all 8,000 users, reducing account compromise incidents by over 60% and eliminating legacy authentication exposure.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, NG-SIEM) and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate, delivering full endpoint visibility and proactive threat hunting capability.
- Led cloud security design reviews for a major Microsoft Azure adoption programme, embedding security controls into infrastructure-as-code, identity governance, and data protection architecture.
- Enabled successful Cyber Essentials Plus recertification by leading remediation of 85+ high-risk vulnerabilities identified through Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io assessments.
- Delivered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) implementation across 300+ privileged accounts, enforcing least privilege and enabling comprehensive session recording for audit and forensic use.
- Built 15+ automated SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps and PowerShell, reducing manual analyst effort by approximately 40% and improving incident response speed and consistency.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)